

Inside view

Conversation 1

- Janet** So tell me about Shakespeare's Globe Theatre, Joe. It looks really old.
- Joe** In fact, it was only built in 1997, but it's on the site of the original Globe Theatre which was the home of Shakespeare's theatre company when he came to London in 1599.
- Janet** So what's the Globe made of?
- Joe** Well, the walls are made of wood, and it's got a thatched roof.
- Janet** Is that the kind of dried grass instead of tiles?
- Joe** That's right. In fact, it's the first thatched building in London since the Great Fire of London in 1666.
- Janet** That's amazing.
- Joe** And inside it's just like the original stage. The audience stands in front of the stage.
- Janet** Are you serious? Aren't there any seats?
- Joe** Yes, there are some seats, but most people stand while they watch the play. So they get soaking wet when it rains. Actually, the strangest thing is when you're watching *Romeo and Juliet* in 16th-century Verona, and suddenly, there's a plane passing over.
- Janet** That's extraordinary!
- Joe** Yes, blows me away.
- Janet** And Andy tells me we've got a report to do on the summer season?

- Joe** Yes, that's right. During the winter it's closed but in May the season starts again.
- Janet** When I think of Shakespeare, I usually think of Stratford-upon-Avon. Where is Stratford-upon-Avon?
- Joe** It's about 130 kilometres from London. Yes, that's where he was born, and it's still the home of the Royal Shakespeare Company. But I kind of see him as a London hero because it's here that he became the greatest playwright the world has ever known.
- Janet** You really think that?
- Joe** I sure do. Let's get back to the studio and edit this.

Conversation 2

- Janet** So when was Shakespeare born?
- Joe** In 1564.
- Janet** And when did he die?
- Joe** In 1616.
- Janet** And when did he come to London?
- Joe** We don't know exactly, but some time between 1585 and 1592.
- Janet** And what did he do in London?
- Joe** He joined a group of actors, and wrote some of his most famous plays, such as *Hamlet*, *The Merchant of Venice*, and *Romeo and Juliet*.
- Janet** So what happened to him later in his life?
- Joe** Well, in 1603, Queen Elizabeth died, and theatre became less popular. And then the Globe Theatre burned down ...
- Janet** And what was the last play he wrote?

Joe It was *The Tempest* – it's often thought that the character of Prospero, the magician, was based on himself.

Janet And does the Royal Shakespeare Company still perform plays in London?

Joe Both in Stratford and London, and they also tour all over the country. I reckon there are about seven or eight Shakespeare plays on in the West End at the moment.

Janet Why do you think he's still so popular?

Joe What I think is great about Shakespeare is that the plays make audiences think. And that makes the audience feel good.

Janet And is it the same in the States?

Joe Maybe not so much. But there's huge respect for Shakespeare's plays on Broadway. I suppose it's because he's still very relevant to audiences today.

Janet Joe, you know so much about Shakespeare! I'm really stunned!

Joe Well, I guess I've seen most of them at one time or another.

Andy Sorry I'm late.

Joe Better once than never, for never too late.

Andy What?

Joe (*The Taming of the Shrew*, Act 5 Scene 1. Better late than never.

Andy Have you finished the edit? Let's upload it onto the website.

Outside view

Presenter Three American cyclists who only have three real legs between them are cycling through Oxford on a trek from Scotland to Greece. The trio sponsored by Ottobock USA all have prosthetic limbs and are hoping the challenge will raise awareness of the diversity of designs available. Six TV caught up with Mick Wright, Sedan Sherret and Brad Kennedy earlier on today.

Cyclist 1 Yeah, it's a little tough. I don't like cycling, but you know, if we can,

you know, help somebody, motivate somebody to get back to an active lifestyle and put their mind to it and do something good, it's all worth it.

Journalist And so what's really the point of this trip?

Cyclist 2 To raise awareness of the abilities of those with disabilities. If you've lost a limb doesn't mean you need to sit on a couch. You can still be active, you can lead a healthy lifestyle and you can do challenges that you may have always wanted to do when you were fully healthy and with two legs.

Journalist And the trip is 2,500 miles from Glasgow to Athens. How are you guys coping?

Cyclist 3 Oh, I think we're doing really well. We're still in the, this is the first week of riding. We're conditioning, we're getting used to the ... we've had spectacular weather, it's been, I mean, we got sunburnt in Scotland. It's, we're, we're getting accustomed to life on the road and every day our pace is increasing and we're getting stronger. So I think it's, it's marvellous.

Journalist And will you, when you get to Athens, what's your plan there?

Cyclist 1 Hopefully take a little time to rest, relax, vacation a little bit, maybe throw the bike in the ocean, just the good things in life.

Journalist And what's been the worst, most difficult thing you've come across so far?

Cyclist 2 We've had some very challenging weather and some challenging hills. But we've actually enjoyed all of it. It's been different but I think all of the riding has been good.

Journalist And how are the legs holding up?

Cyclist 3 Oh great! Now we always say that our prosthetic limbs are the ones that are doing fabulous. It's, it's the, it's the, as we refer to, the "meat leg" that, that might, might be a little weaker. But everybody's riding really strongly and they're just, just performing marvellously.

Listening in

News report

For more than 20 years, Dr Jim Withers has been providing medical care to homeless people in Pittsburgh. To gain their trust and develop a connection with them, Withers dressed like a homeless person, with dirty clothes and dirty hair. Then he searched on the streets, in the alleys and under bridges for people who needed medical care.

At first, he was alarmed to see how sick people on the streets were. There were people of all ages and backgrounds, young, old, people with mental illness, runaway kids, women who had been abused, and war veterans.

What Dr Withers started has grown into a full-time street-based medical programme called Operation Safety Net. In addition to providing medical care on the streets, the programme offers services in a mobile van, drop-in centres and a clinic where the homeless can access medical care.

- 1 What is the news report mainly about?
- 2 How did the doctor gain the trust of the homeless people?
- 3 What do we learn about the homeless from the news report?

Passage 1

Newscaster A US Airways' jet landed in the icy Hudson River in New York this afternoon after apparently hitting a flock of geese. Miraculously, no one was killed and there were few injuries. James Moore, our correspondent at the scene, has more.

James An Airbus 330 took off from La Guardia Airport, New York, at 3.26 pm this afternoon, bound for Charlotte in North Carolina. It had 155 people aboard. Thirty to 45 seconds after take-off, a flock of geese apparently flew into the plane, causing it to lose power in

both engines and one engine to catch fire. Without power the plane was unable to return to La Guardia Airport and the pilot decided to land in the Hudson River in order to avoid crashing in a populated area. Two minutes later the plane made a successful landing in the Hudson and passengers were able to climb out through the emergency exits. The plane immediately started taking in water but fortunately water taxis and boats that had seen the crash were waiting by the aircraft. Passengers and crew stood on the wings of the plane in the icy cold water and were helped into the boats. Over the next hour, as New York watched the event on television, everyone on the plane, including a baby, was safely taken ashore. Several passengers were taken to hospitals for treatment, mostly because of the extreme cold. Their injuries are not reported to be serious. One of the passengers, Alberto Panero, said people had begun praying as the plane approached the river but that everyone had stayed calm. The pilot of the plane has been named as Chesley Sullenberger. Aged 57, he has 29 years' experience of flying and at one time had been a US fighter pilot. Sullenberger was the last to leave the plane and walked up and down it twice to make sure it was empty before climbing out. He has already been described as a hero. The Governor of New York, David Paterson, said at a news conference this afternoon, "I believe now we've had a miracle on the Hudson. This pilot, somehow, without any engines, was somehow able to land this plane, and perhaps without any injuries to the passengers." It's thought that the survival of all on board is because the plane did not break up when it hit the water, and because of the immediate arrival of the water taxis and boats.

Passage 2

- Interviewer** Hi, we're asking people who their personal hero is. Someone they really admire and who's inspired them in some way.
- Paul** Oh, right, interesting.
- Interviewer** Can you tell us a bit about yourself?
- Paul** Sure, my name's Paul Smith. I work at London Zoo.
- Interviewer** London Zoo? Really?
- Paul** Yes, I'm a zoo-keeper. I look after the elephants.
- Interviewer** Elephants! What a great job! So who's your hero, Paul?
- Paul** I've got quite a few heroes. But I guess my biggest hero is Al Gore.
- Interviewer** The American politician. So why him?
- Paul** Well, he's the guy who made people take climate change seriously.
- Interviewer** You're referring to the film, *An Inconvenient Truth*, I take it?
- Paul** That's right. That film proved to people – with statistics and graphs, that kind of thing – that climate change was happening and that it's man-made. Before that, most people believed it was just a few crazy scientists who thought it was happening.
- Interviewer** You work with animals. Do you worry about the effect of the climate on animals?
- Paul** Sure, I do. All these species are going to become extinct. It's terrible.
- Interviewer** It is. Would you say Al Gore's been an inspiration to you?
- Paul** Yes, I would. He's taught me about the importance of taking action when you see something that needs to be done. I do volunteer work for Greenpeace – quite a lot actually. That's the way I do my bit.
- Interviewer** Greenpeace? Excellent. Thanks, Paul. ... Hi, What's your name?
- Clare** Clare Hope.
- Interviewer** What do you do?
- Clare** Well, I'm a mum with two young kids. And I work part-time as an accountant for the Red Cross.
- Interviewer** We're asking people who their personal hero is and if they've inspired them in any way.
- Clare** That's an easy one. Melinda Gates, she's my hero.
- Interviewer** Why's that?
- Clare** Well, she's Bill Gates' wife, one of the richest people in the world. You know, she could so easily do nothing, just enjoy her money. And instead, she co-founded the um ... Bill and Melinda Gates Foundation, I think it's called – and it's one of the biggest private charity organizations in the world. It's donated more than 280 million dollars to various good causes.
- Interviewer** More than 280 million? Now that's a lot of money! She's very active in it, isn't she?
- Clare** Oh yeah, she's a director. Flies all over the world.
- Interviewer** Do you do any work for charity?
- Clare** I make phone calls for Save the Children, asking people to donate. She's a real inspiration, Melinda Gates.

Tales ancient and modern

Inside view

Conversation 1

Andy ... So today, we're meant to be meeting a woman who does walking tours around mysterious London.

Janet What's that about?

Joe Aha! That's what we're going to find out. Apparently, she takes visitors round the mysterious sights of London. Anyway, ask her yourself!

Janet Why me?

Andy We were going to ask you, Janet, if you'd like to do the interview?

Janet Me? But I don't know anything about London!

Andy Which makes you a perfect person to ask some real questions.

Janet I don't believe it.

Joe And if you're any good, we'll upload your interview next week.

Janet I'm not sure what to say. It's great but are you absolutely sure you think I'm OK for this?

Joe Too late, here she comes. Hi, this is Janet ...

Janet Emma, tell us about some of the legendary characters in London.

Emma Well, legendary characters might be complete myths or they may have actually existed. For example, most people believe that the famous detective Sherlock Holmes

must have existed. But in fact, we know he can't have existed.

Janet And what about Guy Fawkes?

Emma Yes, Guy Fawkes did actually exist, and he tried to blow up the Houses of Parliament. But we celebrate him every year on Guy Fawkes' Night every 5th of November, and in fact, he's considered to be one of the most popular people in British history!

Janet And I've heard something about Dick Whittington and his cat?

Emma Dick Whittington is said to have come to London with his cat to seek his fortune. Dick Whittington did exist, but the real story is probably different from the myth. It's true that there was a Richard Whittington, who became Lord Mayor four times. He might have existed but we have no proof that he had a cat.

Janet When's the next walking tour, and where are you going?

Emma Well, the next one is a tour of the ghosts of London. Why not come along next Monday and see?

Janet And what other places do you visit?

Emma We do a gorgeous tour ...

Conversation 2

Andy Well done, Janet! That was a great interview.

Joe Way to go, Janet. Knockout!

Janet Thank you. After a while I forgot about the microphone.

Joe And your questions were good.

- Andy** Smart thinking! That's the way to do it, and we've got a great interview. Let's hear it for Janet.
- Joe** Right! Good for you Janet. You're a genius.
- Janet** Thank you so much for your help.
- Andy** Don't mention it.
- Janet** I couldn't have done it without you.
- Joe** Nonsense. You're a natural.
- Andy** So what have you liked best so far about working with us?
- Janet** So many things, I don't know. I loved the time we spent in the West End.
- Andy** Can you hear me now?
- Janet** Ouch! Yes, that's much louder. And we had a great meal in Chinatown.
- Andy** We certainly did.
- Tony** Now, are you hungry? How about some dimsum and crispy roast duck?
- Janet** Sounds great! I'm starving. Thanks!
- Janet** Shakespeare's Globe. I found that quite ... moving, to be so close to where Shakespeare worked.
- Joe** It's extraordinary, I agree.
- Joe** Actually, the strangest thing is when you're watching *Romeo and Juliet* in 16th-century Verona, and suddenly, there's a plane passing over.
- Janet** That's extraordinary!
- Joe** Yes, blows me away.
- Janet** And Camden Lock ...
- Joe** We had a great time there.
- Joe** It's a very trendy kind of place.
- Janet** And it's got clothes and jewellery, and ...
- Andy** They sell pretty well everything here.
- Janet** It was great. What I really liked was walking along the river around where you lived ... Thanks Andy. So what's next?
- Joe** I think we all need a break!

Outside view

Part 1

- Presenter** Imagine our earliest ancestors telling stories around the fire. In ancient times, storytellers carried with them the knowledge of a society's past. They brought news about what was going on in the present, and they related stories about the great heroes and leaders of their cultures. And at all times in human history, from the ancient past up until the present, mischievous storytellers have created fantastic tales simply to trick people into believing they're true. When the story is told, someone who believes it tells it to a friend, fully convinced that it actually happened. And the story spreads and spreads.
- Man 1** A woman my friend knows had a baby that went blind after he got sunscreen in his eyes.
- Woman 1** That's terrible! Oh, the poor baby!
- Woman 2** A man in our town died after he'd eaten bananas that contained a deadly bacteria.
- Woman 3** Deadly bacteria? No!
- Presenter** All of these stories sound bizarre and terrifying, yet none of them is true. They are all urban legends – stories that are told to trick people into believing that they are true. Urban legends are a type of hoax. Hoaxes are elaborate tricks designed to fool people. A hoax may employ objects or pictures to make the story more believable. Probably the most famous scientific hoax was started by a man in England. He altered a number of bones and fossils and then buried them. Charles Dawson found them and claimed to have found the missing link – a fossil that proved that humans descended from apes. These fossils were called Piltdown man. For 40 years, many people believed Piltdown

man really was the missing link. But in the end, scientists determined that the Piltdown man had been created, using the skulls of medieval humans, the jaw of an orang-utan, the tooth of a hippopotamus, and, the canine tooth of an early chimpanzee. It's still not certain who created Piltdown man, but it was one of the most famous hoaxes ever.

Our gravity reduction story is based on a famous hoax. On April Fool's Day 1976, British astronomer and children's book author Patrick Moore announced on the radio that the planet Pluto would pass behind Jupiter. Many listeners called in and actually claimed to have floated around the room!

During a remarkably warm winter, snow on the top of Mount Ararat in Turkey melted. For the first time, satellites were able to record images of an object that had previously been buried under the snow. These satellite images do, in fact, reveal a mysterious large object which may or may not be Noah's ark.

Stories of the fantastic, the improbable, the bizarre – we love to hear them, we love to tell them, and we want to believe them. And that's why some of us love to make them up.

Part 2

Presenter Would you believe in Piltdown man? Maybe. Maybe not. Let's see how good you are at detecting the truth. I'm going to tell you two stories. One story is based on a famous hoax. The other actually happened. After watching both stories, you decide which one is true. Ready? Story Number One. "Gravity reduction."

Man 2 This has been an aeronautics and space report presented by NASA.

Presenter Scientists at NASA predicted that Neptune would pass in front of Uranus. Using Einstein's theory of relativity, they determined that when the planets were aligned in this way, the pull on the Earth would be powerful enough to diminish the force of gravity. They predicted that if you jumped in the air at that moment, you would feel as if you were floating. Now, are you ready for story Number Two? "Noah's ark found."

Everyone knows the story of Noah's ark. In fact, three of the major world religions – Christianity, Judaism, and Islam – all share the story that the world was destroyed by a flood. Only Noah and those aboard the ark were saved when they landed on top of Mount Ararat in Turkey. But, did it really happen? New satellite pictures of the mountain show an object. It is believed to be the remains of Noah's ark.

Which story is true?

Listening in News report

Official vandalism or a way of bringing legends and history to life? A new carving at the historic Tintagel Castle in the United Kingdom is causing some controversy. English Heritage has unveiled a sculpture of the sleeping face of Merlin, carved into the rocks below the castle. The new artwork is part of a project to bring the legends and history of the castle to life.

Tintagel Castle was first linked to the story of King Arthur in the 12th century. Tintagel was described as the location where Arthur was born, thanks to the magic of Merlin. The location of the new sculpture guards the entrance to Merlin's Cave, so named because, according to legend, it was the cave through which Merlin carried the infant Arthur to safety.

Some people think that it's a beautiful carving and will attract more visitors to the castle in

Cornwall. However, some historians say there is no evidence linking the legend of King Arthur to the castle. Locals have accused English Heritage of damaging property and of promoting a false history.

- 1 What caused the controversy at Tintagel Castle?
- 2 What do we learn about Tintagel Castle from the news report?
- 3 What are local people's opinions of the new artwork?

Passage 1

Human beings have always tried to explain how the universe or world came into existence and all cultures have developed stories, known as creation myths, to explain this. Despite the huge differences in cultures, from African tribes to the Inuit culture in the far north, it is fascinating how many similar themes there are in these myths.

A creation story often begins with the idea of a kind of eternity in which there is nothing but darkness or water. So for one Native American tribe, the Apache, in the beginning there was only darkness. Similarly, the Jewish and Christian Bible creation story describes the earth as being "without form ... and darkness was on the face of the deep." Here, the phrase "the deep" refers to water, the oceans.

Very frequently there is the idea of a creator, either a single creator or creators, in the form of gods. The Jewish, Christian and Islamic religions have a single creator. After stating that darkness was on the face of the deep, the Bible says that the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters. And God said, "Let there be light"; and there was light.

In other creation myths there is more than one god. In Japanese mythology, a god and goddess stir the ocean with a spear, and a small island appears made of salt. The native tribes of New Zealand say that Father Sky and Mother Earth united to create all things. Sometimes the creator is an animal. There are African creation myths where the creator is a huge snake. The Inuit people believed that a bird – the raven – created the world. There is also the idea of a cosmic egg, that breaks open and the world emerges from it. The Ancient Finns believed

that the world was formed when a bird was flying across the sea and found a dry place to lay her eggs. The eggs broke open and created the sky, the sun, and the earth.

Finally, I said at the beginning, that all cultures have a creation myth. This isn't quite true. There is one South American tribe called the Piraha, who live in the Amazon rainforest. They seem to have no creation myth at all, and no idea of time or mathematics.

Passage 2

Presenter OK, folks, we're taking calls on big cat sightings. In the last year more than 2,000 suspected big cat sightings were reported to the police. Are big cats sightings just a myth, or are they really roaming the English countryside? We have our first caller. Hello, Andy from Yorkshire!

Caller 1 Hello. Six months ago I went out one morning to find three of my sheep had been killed. And it certainly wasn't a fox that did it.

Presenter Why not?

Caller 1 Because they'd been killed very violently. It could only have been a big cat of some kind.

Presenter Interesting. We have another caller on the line, Jeff, also a farmer, from Devon this time. He has a very different view.

Caller 2 Actually I'm from Iowa, but I've lived here a long time. And I've got to say, I disagree with the last caller. It could easily just be a very big dog – they can be very dangerous.

Presenter Are you telling me big cats and dogs look alike?

Caller 2 If you see them from a distance, yes.

Presenter Hmm. OK, thanks for the opinion, Jeff. Over to Danielle ... in Scotland.

Caller 3 Hi! I feel sure there are big cats in our area. Eight months ago I found 16 paw prints in my garden and each one measured 20 centimetres.

Presenter Could they've been made by a big dog?

Caller 3 They were much too large to be a dog.

Presenter Did you get an expert in to have a look at the prints?

Caller 3 No.

Presenter Well, how do you know? Hi, Robert ... You've got a story to tell.

Caller 4 That's right.

Presenter So – what happened?

Caller 4 About two years ago. I was walking my dog in the woods near my home and suddenly he howled and just ran, looking absolutely terrified. And there in the undergrowth was some kind of – big black cat.

Presenter Couldn't it have been another dog?

Caller 4 Definitely not. Anyway, I just ran for my life ...

Presenter How many seconds did you see it for?

Caller 4 Um ... Maybe three.

Presenter Was that long enough to be sure it was a big cat?

Caller 4 It was long enough for me ...

Presenter OK, thanks. We've time for one last call. Sandy's from London.

Caller 5 Hi. I have evidence that big cats are real but not in the way we think.

Presenter How do you mean, not in the way we think?

Caller 5 They're from somewhere else. From another world.

Presenter I see! Oh, maybe you can explain a bit more ...